

GRE Vocabulary Notes: Group 5

Group 5 Vocabulary

1. Aloof

Meaning: Distant, unfriendly, or emotionally detached.

Tip to remember: Aloof sounds like “a roof.” Imagine someone standing alone on a roof, away from everyone.

Sentence: He seemed aloof at first, but later became friendly.

2. Clangor

Meaning: A loud, harsh, ringing noise.

Tip to remember: Clangor comes from “clang,” the sound of metal hitting metal.

Sentence: The clangor of the construction site disturbed the students.

3. Conventional

Meaning: Traditional, ordinary, or following accepted customs.

Tip to remember: Think of a convention where people follow common rules and traditions.

Sentence: He rejected a conventional career path and started his own company.

4. Debunk

Meaning: To expose something as false or misleading.

Tip to remember: Think of removing “bunk,” meaning nonsense. Debunk means to remove false ideas.

Sentence: The scientist debunked the myth with clear evidence.

5. Diminutive

Meaning: Very small.

Tip to remember: Diminutive sounds like “diminish,” which means to make smaller.

Sentence: The diminutive puppy followed its mother everywhere.

6. Discernible

Meaning: Able to be seen, noticed, or understood.

Tip to remember: Discern means to detect. Discernible means detectable.

Sentence: There was a discernible improvement in his speaking skills.

7. Enigmatic

Meaning: Mysterious and difficult to understand.

Tip to remember: Enigmatic comes from enigma, meaning mystery.

Sentence: The professor gave an enigmatic smile after hearing the answer.

8. **Estranged**

Meaning: No longer close or affectionate; separated emotionally.

Tip to remember: Estranged sounds like “a stranger.” An estranged friend becomes like a stranger.

Sentence: He was estranged from his family for many years.

9. **Extravagant**

Meaning: Spending too much money or using more than necessary.

Tip to remember: Think of “extra” spending. Extravagant means spending extra and excessively.

Sentence: The wedding was beautiful but extremely extravagant.

10. **Fanciful**

Meaning: Imaginary, unrealistic, or highly imaginative.

Tip to remember: Fanciful comes from fantasy. A fanciful idea may be creative but unrealistic.

Sentence: His fanciful plan to build a city in the sky amused everyone.

11. **Frivolous**

Meaning: Not serious, important, or useful.

Tip to remember: Think of someone wasting time on silly things during an exam week. That is frivolous.

Sentence: The court dismissed the frivolous complaint.

12. **Heterogeneous**

Meaning: Made up of different kinds of parts or people.

Tip to remember: “Hetero” means different. Heterogeneous means different throughout.

Sentence: The class was heterogeneous, with students from many countries.

13. **Imperious**

Meaning: Bossy, arrogant, and expecting obedience.

Tip to remember: Imperious sounds like emperor. An emperor may give orders arrogantly.

Sentence: His imperious tone annoyed his teammates.

14. **Impertinent**

Meaning: Rude or disrespectful; not relevant.

Tip to remember: Think of a student asking a rude, irrelevant question to a teacher. That is impertinent.

Sentence: The interviewer found his impertinent reply unacceptable.

15. **Invasive**

Meaning: Spreading aggressively or intruding into something.

Tip to remember: Invasive comes from invade. Something invasive enters where it is not wanted.

Sentence: Invasive species can damage local ecosystems.

16. **Irresolute**

Meaning: Uncertain; unable to make a firm decision.

Tip to remember: “Resolute” means determined. Irresolute means not determined.

Sentence: He remained irresolute about which university to choose.

17. **Laudable**

Meaning: Worthy of praise.

Tip to remember: Laudable sounds like “applaudable.” If something is laudable, you can applaud it.

Sentence: Her effort to help poor students was laudable.

18. **Lax**

Meaning: Not strict, careful, or disciplined.

Tip to remember: Think of relaxed rules. Lax means too relaxed or careless.

Sentence: Lax security allowed the thief to enter the building.

19. **Marginalize**

Meaning: To treat someone or something as unimportant or powerless.

Tip to remember: Think of writing something in the margin, away from the main page. Marginalized people are pushed to the side.

Sentence: The policy marginalized small farmers.

20. **Panache**

Meaning: Stylish confidence or flair.

Tip to remember: Panache sounds fancy. A person with panache does things with style.

Sentence: She presented her research with great panache.

21. **Plodding**

Meaning: Slow, dull, and steady.

Tip to remember: Think of someone slowly walking through mud: plod, plod, plod.

Sentence: His plodding method was slow but eventually successful.

22. **Prosaic**

Meaning: Ordinary, dull, and lacking imagination.

Tip to remember: Prose is ordinary writing, unlike poetry. Prosaic means plain and ordinary.

Sentence: The topic sounded exciting, but his explanation was prosaic.

23. **Remedial**

Meaning: Intended to correct or improve a weakness.

Tip to remember: Remedial comes from remedy. A remedy fixes a problem.

Sentence: The school offered remedial classes for weak students.

24. **Restive**
Meaning: Restless, impatient, or difficult to control.
Tip to remember: Restive sounds like restless. Both show discomfort and impatience.
Sentence: The audience became restive during the long speech.
25. **Sporadic**
Meaning: Happening occasionally, irregularly, or at scattered intervals.
Tip to remember: Think of rain that comes and stops randomly. That is sporadic rain.
Sentence: He made only sporadic efforts to study vocabulary.
26. **Stigmatize**
Meaning: To mark someone or something with shame or disapproval.
Tip to remember: Stigma means shame. Stigmatize means to attach shame to someone.
Sentence: Society should not stigmatize people who ask for help.
27. **Undermine**
Meaning: To weaken or damage gradually.
Tip to remember: Think of digging under a wall. The wall becomes weak from below. That is undermine.
Sentence: Constant criticism can undermine a student's confidence.
28. **Utterly**
Meaning: Completely or totally.
Tip to remember: Think of saying something with your full mouth, or uttering it fully. Utterly means fully.
Sentence: The answer was utterly wrong.
29. **Weary**
Meaning: Very tired, especially after hard work or stress.
Tip to remember: Weary sounds like "worn." A weary person feels worn out.
Sentence: After studying all night, he felt weary.
30. **Zealous**
Meaning: Very enthusiastic and devoted.
Tip to remember: Zealous comes from zeal, meaning strong enthusiasm.
Sentence: She was zealous in her preparation for the GRE.